

The Moon

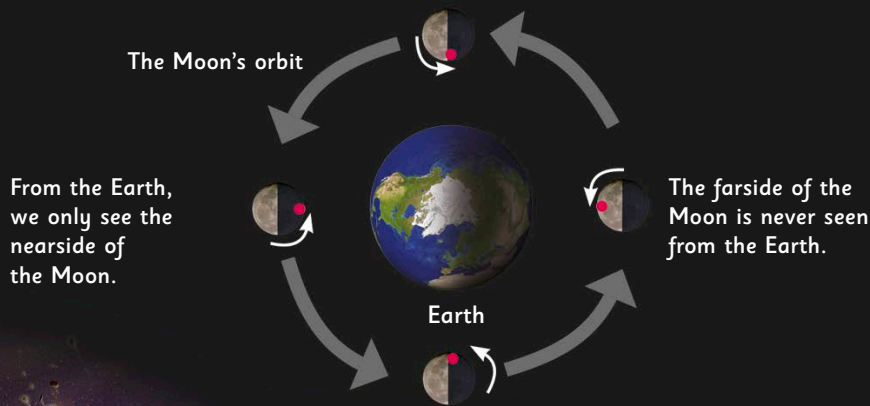
The Earth has one natural satellite – the Moon. It is the brightest object in the night sky (although it doesn't produce its own light). It is a bleak place, with no water, no plants, no air, and no life.

Spinning around and around

It takes 27 days for the Moon to travel around, or orbit, the Earth. As it travels, it spins slowly. It actually spins just once during each orbit of the Earth.



Stretched flat, the Moon's surface would almost cover North and South America.



Only one side of the Moon is...

The Moon may have been formed after an immense collision that sent debris into orbit around the Earth.

How did it form?

Nobody really knows, but it was possibly after the Earth was hit by a Mars-sized asteroid some 4.5 billion years ago.